

THE CMY (WHITE) PAPER

The ZARO Artifact — A ZaroVerse Declaration

C + M + Y = WHITE

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ZaroVerse Ltd. | British Virgin Islands | core@zaroverse.com

The coin is a relic. The universe is the story.

The CMY (White) Paper — On the Name

This is a whitepaper. It is white.

In the CMY color model — the subtractive model that governs all physical printing — Cyan, Magenta, and Yellow combine to produce white. Not emptiness. Not absence. Completeness. The name is the proof.

$$\text{C} + \text{M} + \text{Y} = \text{WHITE}$$

Most whitepapers are white because they are blank. This one is white because $C + M + Y = \text{White}$. That is the lore.

The three colors carry distinct meaning within ZaroVerse:

- Cyan — the digital layer: the blockchain, the code, the transparent machine. Permanent. Immutable. Verifiable.
- Magenta — the creative layer: the stories, the characters, the universe. Emotional. Expansive. Human.
- Yellow — the explorer layer: the early believers, the curious, the ones who find things before they are obvious. Rare. Privileged. Ahead.

When all three are present — when the digital is real, the creative is alive, and the explorer has arrived — the result is white. Complete. Whole.

This document is the combination of all three. What follows is the full declaration of the ZARO artifact: what it is, how it was made, what it is becoming, and why it matters to those who find it now.

Part One — The Artifact

1. What is ZARO?

ZARO is a fixed-supply ERC-20 token deployed on Ethereum on June 29, 2025. One billion tokens. No more. Ever.

This is not a promise. It is a technical fact. The smart contract that governs ZARO has no mint function. Its ownership has been transferred to the zero address. No wallet, no company, no founder, no government, and no algorithm can create ZARO token number 1,000,000,001. The supply ceiling is enforced by mathematics and code — not by policy or the good intentions of a team.

Within the ZaroVerse narrative, ZARO's supply has a story: the mythical Giving Tree of ZaroVerse produces exactly one billion fruits before it rests, forever. The number is not arbitrary. It is the numerical expression of the lore — a deliberate alignment between the on-chain reality and the fictional world the token inhabits.

ZARO is not a currency. Not a utility token granting access to a platform. Not a governance token. Not a yield-bearing asset.

It is a collectible — the on-chain artifact of a fictional universe. Its relationship to ZaroVerse is the same as a physical collectible's relationship to the franchise it represents: it embodies the universe, it is scarce, and it is permanently real.

2. The Clean Launch

ZARO was launched on June 29, 2025, with the following properties — each executed on-chain and independently verifiable:

No Presale: No tokens were sold to investors at a discount before public availability. The first opportunity to acquire ZARO was through the open DEX market on Uniswap V2.

No Team Wallet: ZaroVerse Ltd. holds no privileged token allocation distributed at launch. The founder's holding (195,000,000 ZARO, 19.5% of supply) was acquired at the same public market price available to all buyers, on the same day, through an OTC transaction at open market rates. This transaction is fully on-chain and verifiable.

No Venture Capital: ZARO received no venture capital investment. ZaroVerse Ltd. is self-funded by its founder. No VC holds ZARO at a discounted price waiting for a public listing to exit.

Permanently Locked Liquidity: The initial ETH/ZARO liquidity pool on Uniswap V2 (300,000,000 ZARO paired with 6 ETH) was locked for 255 years via UNCX Network on launch day. This lock is on-chain, irrevocable, and cryptographically enforced.

Renounced Contract: The contract owner address was transferred to the zero address (0x000...000) shortly after deployment. No minting, pausing, blacklisting, or configuration changes are possible by any party — ever.

Zero Tax: There is no buy tax, no sell tax, and no transfer fee. No mechanism exists to extract value from token transactions.

These properties are not claimed. They are documented in the public security repository:

<https://github.com/zarocoin/zarocoin/tree/main/docs/security>

Part Two — The Early Explorer

3. On Transparency and Early Discovery

We made a choice that most projects in this industry never make: we did not announce loudly. We did not pay key opinion leaders. We did not manufacture trading volume. We did not seek exchange listings before the foundation was solid.

We built the token correctly, transparently, and quietly — and we let it exist.

The token launched in what we call the project's 'garage phase': a single founder, a fully formed vision, a clean on-chain structure, and zero marketing expenditure. Every holder who found ZARO during this period did so on their own. Not because an algorithm served them an ad. Not because a paid influencer told them to. Not because a VC needed an exit.

We call the people who found ZARO in its early days the Early Explorers. In an industry where attention is manufactured and distributed by cash, the fact that you are reading this without having been sold to means something.

History is full of these moments — the early readers of a manuscript before it became a bestseller, the early visitors to an artist's first show before the retrospective, the early holders of a collectible before the franchise became a household name. Those people were not lucky. They were paying attention.

ZaroVerse Studios is now activating the full IP engine: published lore and books, merchandise, animated content, games, and a professional marketing operation. The project is transitioning from its quiet founding phase to its public operational phase. The early discovery window is not closed — but it is no longer invisible.

We do not promise that ZARO will be worth more tomorrow. We do not make financial projections. What we can say is this: everything we have built has been done with integrity, on-chain, verifiably, with no hidden moves. The structure is clean. The IP engine is starting to turn. And the people who found this before the world noticed will always be able to say they were here.

Part Three — The Universe

4. ZaroVerse

ZaroVerse is a multi-format fictional universe in active development and publication. It is the world that gives ZARO its meaning.

The universe was not built after the token to justify it retroactively. The token was issued as the artifact of a universe that was already in creative development. This is the distinction between a cultural collectible and a speculative instrument: the IP existed in the creator's vision before the token was deployed.

5. Characters and Lore

ZaroVerse is populated by original characters developed and copyright-registered by ZaroVerse Ltd.:

- Zaro — the central figure of the ZaroVerse universe. A symbol of curiosity, hope, and quiet mischief. Zaro exists across the lore's many chapters as a constant — a character who was always there, even before the audience arrived.
- ARC-7 — a mysterious AI entity from the early history of Ethereum. ARC-7 is a guardian archetype whose role in the ZaroVerse narrative bridges the digital and the mythological.
- More characters are being introduced as the lore expands across formats.

Original fiction in the ZaroVerse universe (Book 1: The Yellow Spark) has been written and copyright-registered. The lore is being published and distributed actively.

6. The Studios Model

ZaroVerse Studios — an operating arm of ZaroVerse Ltd. — is producing the following IP products across multiple formats:

Books and Written Lore: Original fiction set in the ZaroVerse universe, published and in ongoing distribution.

Merchandise: Plush toys, apparel, collectibles, and physical artifacts of the ZaroVerse universe currently in development, targeting Q2–Q3 2026 launch.

Games: Meme Wars — a casual game built around ZaroVerse characters — is in prototype development, targeting Q3 2026.

Animation: Short-form animated content connecting to the ZaroVerse lore, planned for Q4 2026.

Music: Original compositions tied to the ZaroVerse narrative are in production.

Social and Marketing: A professional social media and marketing operation is being activated with specialist support, moving from organic discovery into active audience development.

7. Intellectual Property

ZaroVerse Ltd. holds the following registered intellectual property:

- 9 USPTO trademark filings (all pending) covering: ZARO (word mark), ZARO (logo mark), ZARO (character/mascot), ZAROVERSE, MEMEWARS, ZAROVERSE MEMEWARS, ZaroLand, ARC-7, and related identifiers.
- US Copyright registration: ZARO character (visual and narrative identity), registered June 2025.
- US Copyright registration: ZaroVerse story/lore — Book 1: The Yellow Spark.

The IP model is designed for long-term licensing-first franchise development — comparable in structure and ambition to Hello Kitty (Sanrio), Minions (Universal), and Pudgy Penguins. As the IP reaches wider audiences through merchandise, media, and games, the artifact those audiences discover — ZARO — was on-chain before any of it was mainstream.

Part Four — Tokenomics

8. Token Specification

Name: Zaro Coin

Symbol: ZARO

Canonical Blockchain: Ethereum (ERC-20)

Total Supply: 1,000,000,000 ZARO (immutable hard cap)

Max Supply: 1,000,000,000 ZARO (same — no further issuance possible)

Decimals: 18

Transaction Tax: 0%

Mint Function: None

Pause Function: None

Blacklist Function: None

Upgrade Mechanism: None — non-upgradeable, non-proxy

Contract Owner: Zero address (renounced — permanent)

TGE Date: June 29, 2025

Standard: Thirdweb TokenERC20 / OpenZeppelin ERC-20

9. Contract Addresses

Ethereum (canonical, ERC-20):

0xc311FD6DA9686507F33991543d8158EF5FaDd5E7

BSC (Wormhole-bridged, BEP-20):

0xa9D72F6C1490647DF20E8Fad3C136cA6AC42c2fc

Solana (Wormhole-bridged, SPL):

AbzXS6NfGvCtg5B1rqZ1JSfoDHkwTAeEYJkWkHhCe38W

Base (Wormhole-bridged, ERC-20):

0x1d4CeA73e212829d06B9a774d2e06be9DEe5AAB0

10. Supply Distribution

Allocation	ZARO	%	Status
ETH Uniswap V2 LP	300,000,000	30.0%	Locked 255 years — UNCX
Founder OTC (open market price)	195,000,000	19.5%	On-chain verifiable — no discount
Cross-chain DEX LPs (BSC/SOL/Base)	~209,872,870	~21.0%	Deployed to DEX LPs — locked/burned

Additional LP positions	~295,127,130	~29.5%	In permanent LP — not team-held
Team / private allocation	0	0%	None
VC / investor allocation	0	0%	None

Circulating supply: 704,872,870 ZARO (~70.5%). The remaining ~29.5% is held exclusively in permanent LP positions — not by the team.

11. Multi-Chain via Wormhole

ZARO's canonical contract on Ethereum is the source of truth for supply and ownership. All other chain deployments are bridged representations created via Wormhole — one of the most battle-tested cross-chain protocols in the ecosystem.

ETH LP (Uniswap V2): Locked 255 years via UNCX. TX:

<https://etherscan.io/tx/0xbb17a0d05a167047fb478c9769badaed00fa40e964a54d2917181420d26f4581>

BSC LP (PancakeSwap V2): Active.

Solana LP (Meteora DLMM): Permanently locked via Meteora. Irrevocable.

Base LP (Aerodrome): Permanently burned — sent to 0xdead address. TX:

<https://basescan.org/tx/0x2033eda615044458b723fb9b7a2141ddcd6cc60d5bf9c7cde933c8d2e33da332>

12. Data Listings

ZARO is listed on CoinGecko and CoinMarketCap across all four chains:

CoinGecko: <https://www.coingecko.com/en/coins/zaro-coin>

CoinMarketCap: <https://coinmarketcap.com/currencies/zaro-coin/>

Part Five — Legal Classification

ZaroVerse Ltd. is committed to full regulatory transparency. This section addresses the legal classification of ZARO and is provided to assist exchanges, regulators, and holders in understanding the nature of the token.

13. ZARO is a Collectible, Not a Security

ZARO is classified as a cultural collectible token — specifically, as the on-chain artifact of the ZaroVerse fictional universe. It is not a financial security, an investment contract, a share of equity, or a debt instrument.

ZaroVerse Ltd. holds a formal legal opinion issued by Drew Barnholtz, Esq., The Barnholtz Law Firm, LLC (October 7, 2025), which analyzes ZARO under BVI law and concludes that ZARO is NOT a security under British Virgin Islands law. The opinion also includes a comparative analysis of the US Howey Test.

The public version of the legal opinion is available at:

<https://github.com/zarocoin/zarocoin/tree/main/docs/legal>

14. The Howey Test Analysis

Under the US Supreme Court's Howey Test (SEC v. W.J. Howey Co., 1946), an instrument constitutes an investment contract — and therefore a security — if it involves: (1) an investment of money, (2) in a common enterprise, (3) with an expectation of profits, (4) primarily from the efforts of others. We analyze each prong:

Prong 1 — Investment of Money: ZARO was not sold through any investment contract, ICO, or private sale. It became available through open DEX trading — the same mechanism through which anyone purchases any commodity, collectible, or fungible asset on a public market. Purchasers did not enter into any agreement with ZaroVerse Ltd.

Prong 2 — Common Enterprise: The ZARO contract is renounced. ZaroVerse Ltd. does not control the token supply, the contract behavior, or the liquidity (which is permanently locked or burned). There is no pooling of purchaser funds toward a common enterprise controlled by an issuer. The 'enterprise,' if any, is the open market itself.

Prong 3 — Expectation of Profits: ZARO is explicitly positioned as a cultural collectible — not an investment product. No yield, staking rewards, dividends, or profit expectations are offered or promised anywhere in this document or in any official ZaroVerse communication. Cultural appreciation of an artifact is not the same as an investment expectation under securities law.

Prong 4 — Efforts of Others (the critical prong): Post-renouncement, the owner of the ZARO contract is the zero address. No entity — including ZaroVerse Ltd. — can affect the

token's supply, transaction rules, or on-chain behavior. ZaroVerse Ltd. is a participant in the same ecosystem as any token holder: a community member, not a controller. The fourth prong — the most important prong — does not apply to ZARO after renouncement.

15. The Bitcoin Analogy

When Coinbase, Binance, or any exchange lists Bitcoin, no one contacts Satoshi Nakamoto for permission. Bitcoin has no controlling party. Any exchange listing Bitcoin is listing a public smart contract whose behavior is governed entirely by its code — not by a person, a team, or a company.

ZARO, after renouncement, is in the same structural position. The contract owner is the zero address. No entity controls the supply or behavior of ZARO. An exchange listing ZARO is listing a public smart contract — not a company-issued security. This is a regulatory strength, not a complication.

16. Jurisdiction and Global Availability — Including the United States

ZARO is available globally, including to participants in the United States. This is not a legal risk — it is a legal strength. Here is why:

No issuer relationship: The ZARO smart contract owner is the zero address. ZaroVerse Ltd. does not sell ZARO to anyone. There is no issuer-buyer relationship. US participants interact directly with a public, ownerless smart contract on Ethereum — the same way they would purchase any commodity on an open market.

No promoter, no effort of others: The fourth Howey prong — profit from the efforts of others — does not apply to ZARO post-renouncement. No person or entity controls the contract, the supply, or the liquidity. There are no 'efforts of others' that a US participant is relying upon.

Liquidity cannot be withdrawn: The primary ETH/ZARO liquidity pool is locked for 255 years via UNCX, enforced on-chain. There is no mechanism by which any party — including ZaroVerse Ltd. — can remove liquidity and harm holders. This eliminates the principal risk that US regulators associate with token issuers.

The Bitcoin Standard: When a US citizen buys Bitcoin, no one calls Satoshi Nakamoto to verify their eligibility. Bitcoin is a public smart contract with no owner, no issuer, and no controlling party. ZARO, after renouncement, is in the same structural position. An exchange listing ZARO for US customers is listing a public, ownerless, permissionless contract — not a security issued by a company.

ZaroVerse Ltd. is incorporated in the British Virgin Islands (Company No. 2183451) and maintains an operational presence in the UAE (Dubai, License No. 1554666). The company does not restrict access to ZARO by geography. Holders in all jurisdictions are individually responsible for their own compliance with applicable local laws and regulations.

A formal standalone US Howey opinion is in preparation and will be commissioned and published upon engagement with a US-accessible exchange. ZaroVerse Ltd. is committed to full legal transparency.

Part Six — Security and Technical Integrity

17. Smart Contract

The ZARO smart contract is based on Thirdweb's TokenERC20 implementation — itself built on OpenZeppelin's ERC-20 standard, the most widely audited token implementation in the Ethereum ecosystem.

Contract standard: Thirdweb TokenERC20 / OpenZeppelin ERC-20

Audit: Thirdweb Smart Contract Audit — audit-12.pdf (public)

Ownership: Renounced — zero address. Permanent and irreversible.

Mint function: None — supply is fixed at deployment and cannot increase

Pause function: None

Blacklist function: None

Upgrade mechanism: None — non-upgradeable, non-proxy

Tax mechanism: None — 0% on all transactions

Audit report (public):

<https://github.com/thirdweb-dev/contracts/blob/main/audit-reports/audit-12.pdf>

18. Security Scan — Blockaid

ZARO has been reviewed by Blockaid, the leading web3 security provider used by MetaMask, Coinbase Wallet, Phantom, and major exchanges globally. ZARO is confirmed clean across all four chains with no malicious flags of any kind.

19. Liquidity Security

The ZARO liquidity layer is secured at the smart contract level, not by policy:

ETH LP — 255-year lock:

Lock TX: 0xbb17a0d05a167047fb478c9769badaed00fa40e964a54d2917181420d26f4581

<https://etherscan.io/tx/0xbb17a0d05a167047fb478c9769badaed00fa40e964a54d2917181420d26f4581>

Base LP — permanently burned:

Burn TX: 0x2033eda615044458b723fb9b7a2141ddcd6cc60d5bf9c7cde933c8d2e33da332

<https://basescan.org/tx/0x2033eda615044458b723fb9b7a2141ddcd6cc60d5bf9c7cde933c8d2e33da332>

Solana LP — permanently locked:

Locked via Meteora DLMM's irrevocable lock mechanism.

20. Security Documentation

Full per-chain security documentation, contract verification, transparency reports, and security profiles are publicly available:

<https://github.com/zarocoin/zarocoin/tree/main/docs/security>

Verified contract block explorers:

Ethereum:

<https://etherscan.io/token/0xc311FD6DA9686507F33991543d8158EF5FaDd5E7>

BSC:

<https://bscscan.com/token/0xa9D72F6C1490647DF20E8Fad3C136cA6AC42c2fc>

Solana:

<https://solscan.io/token/AbzXS6NfGvCtg5B1rqZ1JSfoDHkwTAeEYJkWkHhCe38W>

Base:

<https://basescan.org/token/0x1d4CeA73e212829d06B9a774d2e06be9DEe5AAB0>

Part Seven — The Road Ahead

The following is a transparent statement of ZaroVerse Studios' current development priorities and intended timeline. It is not a financial projection. It does not constitute a commitment to deliver specific financial outcomes.

21. Roadmap

Q2–Q3 2026

- First centralized exchange listings (applications submitted to Binance, MEXC, Bitget, OKX, and Coinbase — additional major exchanges to follow)
- Merchandise launch: plush toys, apparel, and collectible physical artifacts
- Social media and marketing activation — ZaroVerse Studios marketing engine live
- Expanded lore publishing and story releases

Q3–Q4 2026

- Meme Wars game — prototype and early public release
- Animated short-form content for social media and streaming platforms
- Music releases connected to the ZaroVerse narrative

2027 and Beyond

- Global IP licensing partnerships — brand collaborations, media deals
- ZaroVerse institutional and media partnerships
- Physical and digital merchandise expansion
- ZaroLand — a long-term experiential and theme park concept under development

Part Eight — The Team

22. Founder

ZARO and ZaroVerse were built by a single founder. This was a deliberate choice: to build something real before building a team around it — to have the substance precede the structure.

Name: Shihab Khalil

Role: Founder & CEO, ZaroVerse Ltd.

Education: Software & Computer Engineering (Wright State University, 1998) | MBA (New York Institute of Technology, 2004) | LLM — International Law & Global Leadership (2011)

Other company: Founder & CEO, ZagTrader (est. 2008) — a multi-asset trading platform providing OMS/EMS, risk, compliance, and market data solutions to banks, brokers, and exchanges globally.

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/shihab>

Twitter/X: <https://x.com/shihabkhalil>

23. Company

Legal entity: ZaroVerse Ltd.

Jurisdiction: British Virgin Islands (Company No. 2183451)

Incorporation date: August 1, 2025

UAE presence: Dubai, UAE (License No. 1554666)

Website: <https://www.zaroverse.com>

Contact: core@zaroverse.com

Funding: Self-funded — no external investors, no venture capital, no fundraising rounds

Part Nine — The Invitation

Most documents like this one end with a call to action: 'Buy our token.' 'Join our community.' 'Don't miss out.'

This is not that.

We are not trying to sell you anything. The contract is renounced — we cannot benefit from new issuance. The liquidity is locked — we cannot pull it. The supply is fixed — there is no printing press.

What we are saying is simpler: ZaroVerse is being built. The IP engine is beginning to turn. The token that was placed on Ethereum on June 29, 2025 — quietly, without fanfare, without paid promoters, without a manufactured listing — is the artifact of what is being built.

Whether you are a holder who found ZARO before you read this document, or someone encountering it for the first time — you are in the early chapter of a story that has not yet been told to most people. Not the last chapter. The early one.

The Giving Tree has already produced its fruits. All one billion of them. They are on Ethereum, on BSC, on Solana, on Base. They will never produce more. The tree is at rest.

What happens next is the story of what those fruits become. That story is being written.

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— ZaroVerse Studios
May 2026

References and Links

Token Website: <https://www.zarocoin.xyz>

ZaroVerse Universe: <https://www.zaroverse.com>

GitHub Repository: <https://github.com/zarocoin/zarocoin>

Whitepaper (this doc): <https://github.com/zarocoin/zarocoin/blob/main/docs/whitepaper/>

Security Documentation: <https://github.com/zarocoin/zarocoin/tree/main/docs/security>

Legal Opinion (public): <https://github.com/zarocoin/zarocoin/tree/main/docs/legal>

Trademarks (public): <https://github.com/zarocoin/zarocoin/tree/main/docs/trademarks>

Audit Report: <https://github.com/thirdweb-dev/contracts/blob/main/audit-reports/audit-12.pdf>

CoinGecko: <https://www.coingecko.com/en/coins/zaro-coin>

CoinMarketCap: <https://coinmarketcap.com/currencies/zaro-coin/>

DexScreener (ETH):

<https://dexscreener.com/ethereum/0x53085839a2ee860e58108665825fc7ef5e061213>

Twitter/X: <https://x.com/zaroproject>

Telegram: <https://t.me/zaroprojectofficial>

Instagram: <https://www.instagram.com/zaroproject>

TikTok: <https://www.tiktok.com/@zaroproject>

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